

Team Name: ***Flaw State***

Team Members:

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GitHub Repo: <https://github.com/Thabo-S/IMY300>

Recently Played Games:

- Njabulo: Call of Duty, UNO, Among Us
- Thabo: Ghost of Tsushima, Ready Or Not, Fortnite
- Lerato: Ghost of Tsushima, Assassins creed Mirage, Cyberpunk 2077
- Tadiwanashe: Wurthing Waves, Dead by Daylight, GTA online

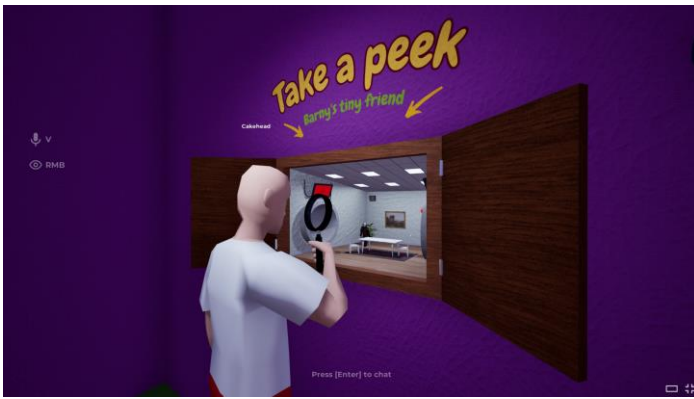
Gameplay Loop

1. **Phase 1 (The Scan):** Player 1 enters. They have around 30 seconds or so, to memorize the items in the room. They can possibly interact with stuff to see their properties, i.e. weight, material type or how it sounds.

Phase 2 (The Saboteur): Player 2 enters. They have a limited budget of "Chaos Currency" that they can use to move, recolour, change material type or delete items. Players will be given a certain amount of Chaos Currency (CC) at the beginning of each round. If the saboteur wins the round by not having their item discovered, then they receive CC and if players who are searching find the changed item/items they get CC.

Phase 3 (The Reveal): Player 1 returns. They must identify the changes by interacting with the items if they choose to or just by tagging the items (they can mark a location where an item was removed, only if it was removed. If an item was moved from location A to B, they must identify the item not the location). Player 2 stays in the room as a ghost/drone to talk trash and mislead them.

2. Screenshots that inspired the gameplay.



The Anomaly Project

https://store.steampowered.com/app/2960770/The_Anomaly_Project

3. **The Anomaly Project** inspired the “spot the difference” core loop and uses the unsettling environments where small changes can create high tension in what the player perceives. However, The Anomaly Project is a Player vs Environment experience with scripted anomalies, our game is primarily a Player vs Player experience that implements a **Round Robin Format**. So instead of finding pre-set anomalies/glitches made by the developers, on player acts as the **Saboteur**, physically making changes to the items in the rooms in real time, which shifts the focus from just simple pattern recognition to competition and social gaslighting, where the **Saboteur** must use voice chat to distract the **Seeker** from remembering.

4. Screenshots that inspired the aesthetic of the game.



https://store.steampowered.com/app/1977530/Onearmed_cook/
https://store.steampowered.com/app/3333740/Exit_Together/

5. Our game applies the “spot the difference” loop gameplay inspired by **The Anomaly Project** and **Exit Together**, but using a medium-fidelity, liminal environments as a baseline for memory challenges. While those games focus more on the scripted side of the “spot the difference” style, ours integrates the chaotic, physics-based interactions as seen in **One-armed cook**. The game replaces the scripted glitches/anomalies with physics-based interactions, allowing players to manually grab and move objects around. By using a round robin format, the experience shifts from just observation to a competitive mental battle, where players take turns sabotaging the room and testing each other’s memory.

Second Game Idea:

Refined core Combat and exploration mechanics

The player will be climbing up a tower where each floor has monsters/creatures that the player will be battling against with a party of three members (3 characters) which they will be able to control one of the characters one at a time. In order for the player to proceed to the next floor, they have to beat the main boss. (which they have to complete a respective quest for the respective floor)

A. Combat mechanics:

The player must focus on two main combat mechanics in the game. One for against Exploration Enemies and the other against the Floor Boss battle (Main floor enemy). The party of three has their own individual weapon, where each weapon is best suited against certain types of enemies and weak against others. For example: the Sword-User character is strong against small enemies and vampires, but weak against flying or big enemies.

For the Boss battle floor mechanics. The combat mechanics are completely different from the Exploration one. It’s not based on the weapon system like the exploration one, but on element power system. Where there’s three elements, Fire, water and Rock. Certain bosses are resisted to certain elements and weak against others. Example: Fire Boss is weak against water, resisted to fire and normal damage from the Rock element.

Player can obtain Artefacts with certain attributes to help fight against the boss by exploring the floors and finding chests.

2.



References:

Left: <https://www.rockpapershotgun.com/hollow-knight-silksong-is-faster-prettier-and-harder-yet-still-feels-like-a-safe-sequel>

Right: <https://www.npr.org/2025/09/08/nx-s1-5533199/hollow-knight-silksong>

3. In **Hollow Knight**, players use the same core combat system throughout the game, but boss fights feel distinct due to arena design, difficulty spikes, and the need for preparation through charms and upgrades. My game adopts this idea of contrasting gameplay phases; however, instead of keeping one consistent combat system, it fully separates the mechanics between exploration and boss battles. In the exploration, the player controls a party of three characters, each with unique weapons that are strong against certain enemy types and weak against others, encouraging strategic switching and tactical decision-making. In contrast, boss fights abandon the weapon advantage system entirely and introduce an elemental combat system based on Fire, Water, and Rock.

4.



Refence:<https://blastawaythegamereview.com/2018/09/25/review-the-banner-saga-trilogy/>



Refences: <https://igabiba.com/products/banner-saga-trilogy-ps4>

5) The games aesthetic is inspired by Banner Sage trilogy. The combination of rich colour palettes, detailed environments, and expressive character art demonsstrates how a distinctive art style can enhance storytelling and player engagement, which I aim to replicate in my game by creating a unique visual identity that supports both exploration and combat elements.